

# Pavan Kumar Nayakanti

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior SRE leader who builds India engineering teams to world-class status. Grew ADP's Hyderabad SRE org from 4 to 35 engineers operating as a true peer of the US organisation - managing follow-the-sun on-call rotations across India, Canada, and the US for 24/7 coverage of mission-critical financial platforms. Initiated and led an AI-in-operations programme: AIOps-driven automated remediation (MTTR ~40%) → GenAI risk summarisation and LLM-based Q&A at BMO, building the case for AI-first SRE. Holds a Master's in Artificial Intelligence and AI-102 certification, with demonstrated ability to evaluate LLM-generated code for production use. 22 years of SRE and platform engineering leadership across ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO, RBC, and Microsoft - presented SRE strategy and reliability outcomes directly to C-suite stakeholders at Fortune 500 clients.

## CORE COMPETENCIES

India Org Building & Elevation

Follow-the-Sun SRE Operations

AI Strategy for SRE Organisations

AIOps & Automated Remediation

SLO/SLI/Error Budget Governance

Chaos Engineering & Resiliency

Toil Elimination & Platform Automation

Distributed Systems at Scale

LLM-Based Operational Tooling

Executive-Level SRE Communication

## WORK EXPERIENCE

**IRIS Software** Sep 2020 - Present

**Engineering Manager / SRE Lead - Cloud Practice** | India (Clients: ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO)

- Scaled ADP's Hyderabad SRE organisation from 4 to 35 engineers** across India, Canada, and the US - established a competency model, structured career paths, and quarterly training (200+ participants per session), transforming the India team from a support satellite into a fully independent SRE org peer.
- Managed follow-the-sun on-call rotations** across India, Canada, and US for ADP's 35-member SRE team - built the India coverage window that reduced US night on-call load by ~50%, with India SREs holding full decision-making authority for their shift.
- Initiated AI-in-operations programme:** Phase 1 - AIOps automated remediation (Dynatrace → Ansible + Python runbooks, MTTR ~40%); Phase 2 - GenAI risk summarisation and LLM-based Q&A at BMO (BCRG/LTS pipelines); Phase 3 - evaluating LLM-assisted intelligent runbooks as next evolution of toil elimination.
- Built Charles Schwab's 18-member Platform Engineering team from zero** - foundational SRE practices, SLO/SLI/error budget frameworks, reliability reviews, and incident governance across a regulated financial platform.
- Drove toil elimination at scale:** modeas deployment platform handling 200+ builds/hour, eliminating 10,000+ manual operational hours annually; AIOps remediation eliminating manual on-call response for known failure classes.
- Defined SLO/SLI/error budget frameworks across ADP, Schwab, and BMO; established chaos engineering practice (Keptn); presented SRE strategy and reliability outcomes to C-suite stakeholders at all three clients quarterly.

**IRIS Software** Jun 2018 - Sep 2020

**Automation Technology Specialist** | Toronto, Canada (Client: Royal Bank of Canada Insurance)

- Established SRE and DevSecOps principles across 250+ applications** within RBC's DevSecOps programme: observability standards (Splunk log aggregation + alerting), SOX/GDPR compliance gates, and automated change evidence pipelines.
- Designed the Robo Deployment Framework - Kubernetes-native CI/CD orchestration with self-healing and compliance gates - reducing application onboarding from 5 weeks to 5 hours; migrated 250+ applications across 60+ teams to GitHub.

**IRIS Software** Feb 2017 - Jun 2018

**Automation Architect** | Toronto, Canada (Clients: Insurance & Capital Markets)

- Designed fault-tolerant, Kubernetes/Helm-orchestrated deployment pipelines for zero-downtime rollouts in capital markets; standardised Python automation frameworks across regulated financial platforms.

**Microsoft Corporation** Jul 2007 - Dec 2014

**Sr. SDET - Automation Architect** | India

- Sustained 99.99% platform uptime over 7 years** on Microsoft's global marketing platforms - proactive SLI monitoring, automated recovery, postmortem-driven continuous improvement, and self-healing cloud architectures supporting 200% user growth with zero critical incidents.

**TechMahindra** - Technology Manager (2015-2017): Enterprise DevOps transformation, global engineering teams, CI/CD adoption.  
**Semantic Space / DRDO / NFC** (2002-2007): Mission-critical systems, L3 production support, software engineering for regulated and defence environments.

KEY PROJECTS

AI-in-Operations Programme (ADP + BMO) AI Strategy

Multi-phase programme driving AI adoption across SRE operations: Phase 1 - AIOps automated remediation (Dynatrace alerts → Ansible+Python runbooks, MTTR -40%, zero manual intervention for known failures); Phase 2 - GenAI risk summarisation + LLM-based Q&A at BMO, reducing manual analysis effort in regulated banking; Phase 3 - LLM-assisted intelligent runbooks to eliminate remaining manual toil. AI-102 certified with Master's in AI enabling LLM code evaluation for production readiness.  
Dynatrace · Ansible · Python · Azure OpenAI · AWS Bedrock · LLM · Prometheus · Grafana

ADP Hyderabad SRE Org: 4 → 35 Engineers Org Building

Built ADP's India SRE capability from 4 engineers into a 35-member organisation spanning India, Canada, and the US - operating as a true peer (not satellite) of the US org. Established competency model, career paths, follow-the-sun on-call rotations with full India decision-making authority, blameless postmortem culture, chaos engineering (Keptn), and SLO governance. Training programme reached 200+ participants per quarter across three Fortune 500 clients.  
Kubernetes · Prometheus · Grafana · Dynatrace · Keptn · Ansible · ITIL · SLO/SLI

modeas - High-Throughput Deployment Platform Toil Elimination

Enterprise-grade deployment automation handling 200+ builds/deployments per hour - eliminated 10,000+ manual operational hours annually and accelerated deployment cadence by 600%. Embedded automated rollback, drift detection, and self-healing recovery, improving operational resilience to 99.9% across all client platforms.  
Kubernetes · Helm · Terraform · Ansible · Python · GitHub Actions · AWS · Azure

EDUCATION

|                                                       |      |
|-------------------------------------------------------|------|
| Masters in Artificial Intelligence — Woolf University | 2024 |
| General Management Program (GMP) — ISB Hyderabad      | 2022 |
| M.Sc in Computer Science — Osmania University         | 2002 |

CERTIFICATIONS

AI-102 Azure AI Solution Design (2025) | CKAD Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (2025) | ISRE Certified SRE | AZ-305 Azure Solutions Architect Expert (2026) | AWS SAA-C01 Solutions Architect Associate (2026) | ITIL Certificate in IT Service Operations | PMI-ACP

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI & AIOps: LLM Evaluation (Azure OpenAI, AWS Bedrock), AIOps, GenAI Deployment, Intelligent Runbooks, Anomaly Detection, AI-102, Masters in AI  
Reliability & Observability: SLI/SLO, Error Budgets, Chaos Engineering (Keptn), Blameless Postmortems · Prometheus, Grafana, Dynatrace, Splunk, AppDynamics  
Containers & Cloud: Kubernetes, Docker, Helm · AWS, Azure, GCP · Terraform, Ansible, CloudFormation, AWS CDK  
Engineering & Automation: Python, Go, Bash, Groovy · GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Jenkins · ITIL, ServiceNow · Linux (advanced)